096. Al-'Alaq ~ The Clot

19 Ayaat (Makki)

FOCUS

CLOSENESS TO CREATOR THROUGH AWAKENING
OF INTELLIGENCE AND SUBMISSION
FIRST FIVE VERSES OF THE QUR'AN TO BE REVEALED
WITH AN EXHORTATION TO READ

DID YOU KNOW?

THE FIRST ORDER TO HUMANITY WAS IQRA' (READ). THROUGH THIS ONE WORD, THE QUR'AN BECAME THE MOST READ, PRINTED AND REPRODUCED BOOK.

THE FIRST VERSE ORDERS THE READING OF THE QUR'AN IN THE NAME OF ALLAH AND THUS EVERY RECITATION BEGINS WITH THE BASMALLAH.

SELECTED AYAAT

96:1	Read! In the name of your Lord who created
96:5	Taught the human being that which he did not know
96:6	Nay! For sure, the human being rebels
96:7	Because he sees himself self-sufficient
96:19	No! Do not obey him. But prostrate and draw near to Allah

NARRATIVE

THE CHAPTER BEGINS WITH THE FIRST FIVE VERSES REVEALED TO THE PROPHET THROUGH THE ANGEL JIBRAAIL IN THE CAVE OF HIRA ON THE MOUNTAIN OF LIGHT WHERE HE USED TO GO TO MEDITATE. THIS BEGAN THE JOURNEY OF THE REVELATION OF THE QUR'AN.

THE CHAPTER STARTS WITH AN EXHORTATION OF READING, LEARNING AND WRITING FOR CLOSENESS TO ALLAH IS ONLY ACHIEVED THROUGH KNOWLEDGE AND UNDERSTANDING. IT CONTINUES WITH THE CAUSE OF REBELLIOUSNESS WHICH IS ARROGANCE AND A LACK OF INTELLECTUAL HUMILITY WHEN APPROACHING DIVINE WORDS.

A HISTORICAL EXAMPLE OF ONE WHO PERCEIVED HIMSELF TO BE INDEPENDENT OF DIVINITY FOLLOWS WITH THE CONSEQUENCES OF HIS ACTIONS.

FINALLY, THE SURA ENDS WITH THE ORDER TO PROSTRATE IN TOTAL SUBMISSION. THIS IS AN OBLIGATORY SAJDA OF RECITATION (VERSE 19)